range of 192.168.0.2 and 192.168.0.254.

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --ipadd 192.168.0.253 --save
# vzctl start 101
```

a) *vzctl stop 101*: This is self-explanatory; it stops a running container so that we can make the changes in configuration. Although it is not necessary to stop a container before making changes, I recommend it to avoid any inconsistencies.
b) *set:* This is a switch used to set various parameters for a container. All these settings go into the configuration file of a container, which for this particular case is */etc/sysconfig/vz-scripts/101.conf*.
c) *--ipadd*: This is the switch used to add an IP address to this container.
d) *192.168.0.253*: This is the IP address, of course.
e) *--save:* This is the switch to save the configuration file. It is necessary, otherwise, on the next boot, this container's IP address will be reverted to the one to which it was set before the change (it will be set to 'None' if no IP address was assigned).
f) *vzctl start 101:* This starts the container with *CTID 101*, after the changes are made successfully.

Changing the IP address for a container: Sometimes, you might want to change the IP address for a container that has already been assigned some different IP. This is a two-step process: 1) delete the old IP address, and 2) add the new IP address. This is because a single container can have multiple IP addresses, and if you want to add another IP address to a specific container, do not run the *--ipdel* command.

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --ipdel all --save
# vzctl set 101 --ipadd 192.168.0.251 --save
# vzctl start 101
```

a) *--ipdel all*: This is used to delete all the IP addresses associated with this container.

Changing the hostname of a container:

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --hostname server101.mydomain.com --save
# vzctl start 101
```

If you do not set any hostname, the default hostname will be used, that is, *localhost.localdomain*

Changing DNS name server entry:

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --nameserver 8.8.8.8 --save
# vzctl start 101
```

Name servers are necessary in the configuration in order to access the Internet. If you do not provide them, you won't be able to ping *www.google.com*, although you will be able to ping any IP address. Basically, this entry specifies the DNS server for name to IP conversions. In the above example, I used Google's open DNS servers, but you can do that only provided your container can access the Internet. This entry goes to the */etc/resolv.conf* file inside the container.

Changing the name of the container:

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --name new_name --save
# vzctl start 101
```

Setting the container to be started on host reboot:

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --onboot yes --save
# vzctl start 101
```

This option is somewhat important if you are going to reboot your server (host machine) a lot. You can mark a container to start on boot, or not. This is also important if you have clients who have purchased virtual servers from you. If, for some reason, your host machine goes down (I hope not), then containers which are not marked to start on server reboot will not be started automatically.

Changing physical memory (RAM) and SWAP space for a container:

```
# vzctl stop 101
# vzctl set 101 --ram 512M --swap 1G --save
# vzctl start 101
```

Make sure to set these values as per the right usage to avoid issues such as killed processes, slowness while performing tasks, etc, inside a container. For example, if you have 4096MB of RAM on your host machine, then always set a lower value for RAM for any container. As the resources are shared and not dedicated between the containers, you can surely provide more RAM to containers, but issues arise when the usage increases and containers use all the memory. At that point, it is advisable to increase the host machine's RAM; otherwise, the processes will be killed intermittently, eventually creating more serious issues.

In order to read about SWAP space, refer to the article at *http://www.centos.org/docs/5/html/5.1/Deployment_Guide/s1-swap-what-is.html*

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